

Merge Conflict

GENESIS
INNOVATE, IDEATE, INSPIRE

This debate will be carried out in an Oxford-style format, with the specific modification that the audience vote will not be counted; the final decision will rely solely on the judges' votes.

Number of Participants

- Each team will consist of exactly 2 participants: one speaker arguing FOR the motion and one speaker arguing AGAINST the motion.

General Guidelines

- The debate will be conducted entirely in English.
- Participants will be evaluated based on the quality of their content and their mode of delivery.
- The judges' decision is final and binding in all matters regarding the competition.

Rules for the Prelims (Elimination Round)

- The topic for the prelims will be provided shortly after the submission of registration forms.
- Each speaker is allotted a maximum of 3 minutes to present their arguments. A warning bell will sound at the 2-minute mark.
- Teams will qualify for the Final Round based on their performance in this elimination stage.

Rules for the Finals

- The topic for the Final Round will be announced to the qualifying teams by the moderator immediately after the prelims conclude.
- Teams will be granted 45 minutes of preparation time before the Final Round begins.
- The moderator will decide the serial order of the presentations.
- Each speaker will have 3 minutes to speak. A warning bell will ring at 2 minutes, and a final bell at the 3-minute mark. Any arguments made after the final bell will not be evaluated.
- The speeches will be followed by a 1-minute rebuttal phase.
- During the rebuttal, teams are limited to asking exactly ONE question. Questions must be specific and highly relevant to the debate.

Allowed

- Speakers may carry a pen and paper onto the stage for reference.
- During the 35-minute preparation period for the finals, teams may use the Computer Lab and refer to the internet for research.
- Speeches should be primarily original, though internet research can inform the arguments.

Not Allowed

- Speakers are strictly prohibited from reading their speeches directly from a prepared script or paper on stage.
- The use of unparliamentary language is completely forbidden.
- Participants must avoid making controversial or derogatory statements.
- Teams may not receive any assistance from their teachers during the 45-minute final round preparation time.
- Members of the same team are not allowed to question each other during the rebuttal phase.